



Britain & Ireland Highlights

Welcome & Tour Tips

Good to have you here. This page covers the practical things worth knowing before we set off from London.

You do not need to remember everything. Once the tour begins, I'll guide everyone through things step by step.

For official timings, inclusions and documents, please refer to your Trafalgar information.

Before we meet in London

-  Know your London hotel and confirm your Day 1 meeting time & place from your welcome email.
-  Know how you are getting from the airport to the hotel before you leave home.
-  Keep your passport, medication, phone, charger and valuables in your day bag — not your main suitcase.

DEPARTURE FROM LONDON

Your first morning

Our tour departs from London in the morning. Your welcome email confirms the hotel and the exact departure time — aim to be ready and down for breakfast before we set off.

Departure morning

Have breakfast before our meeting time — it is a long first day and a good start helps. Know where your luggage is and what is happening with it on departure morning, and keep your day essentials ready so things feel smooth when we board. It also helps to use the WC/restroom before boarding — comfort stops come regularly, but the coach will be moving shortly after departure.

Boarding the coach

The reception area can be busy on departure morning with luggage being loaded and people gathering. If you prefer to wait near the coach rather than in reception, that is absolutely fine.

The key thing is to board at the instructed time. If you are unsure where the coach is or where to go, just ask at reception — or look for me.

Pre-night & portage: Some travellers may have a Trafalgar pre-night package with portage on departure morning, while others may have pre-nights booked independently — sometimes at a different hotel. If you are unsure what applies to your booking, check your welcome email and joining documents.

MUST KNOW



Before you travel

A quick check of these details before leaving home makes the start feel much smoother.



Confirm your joining details

Your welcome email and joining documents confirm your London hotel and the departure time. Keep those details somewhere easy to access — you will want them on arrival day.

If you are unsure about any joining details before travel, reach out to European Guest Services using the contact details in your welcome email.



Getting to your London hotel

If you are flying in, confirm how you are getting from the airport to the hotel before you travel. Trafalgar may offer a transfer — check your documents for timings and where to meet.

Complimentary transfers run at set times and cannot be held. If you are making your own way, official London Black Cabs and apps such as Uber are easy to use at all London airports.

If your arrival time changes and you have a private transfer booked through Trafalgar, update your transfer provider using the contact details in your welcome email.



Day bag essentials

Your main suitcase goes into the coach hold on travel days and may not be accessible until you reach the next hotel. Keep anything you might need during the day with you:

- Glasses, contact lenses or hearing aids
- Medication and prescription items
- Phone, charger and any cables
- Cards, cash and travel money
- A waterproof layer — weather changes quickly here

A useful rule: if you would miss it for a few hours, it belongs in your day bag.

Passport & documents: Know where your passport is at all times — keep it with you, not packed in your main suitcase, on days when we have a ferry crossing or cross a border. It is also good habit to carry some form of ID on your person day to day. **Entry & visa requirements** can vary by nationality — your Trafalgar documents include guidance, and I recommend checking your government's official travel advice before departure.

GOOD TO KNOW



Before you pack

These are the details that tend to make the biggest practical difference.



Walking shoes

This tour covers a lot of ground on foot — castle grounds, old city streets, historic sites and longer sightseeing days. Comfortable, well-worn shoes make a real difference across the whole tour, not just on one day.

If you are unsure which pair to bring, bring your most comfortable ones.



Weather and layers

Weather across Britain and Ireland can shift quickly — within a few hours, and from one region to the next. You might get a bit of everything in one day, which is fairly normal here.

A waterproof jacket you trust, a mid-layer, and comfortable shoes will do most of the heavy lifting. Treat the forecast as a guide rather than a guarantee.



"Today's rain is tomorrow's whisky."

– A local favourite in both Scotland and Ireland



Power adapters

England, Scotland, Wales, Northern Ireland and the Republic of Ireland all use the same plug — the UK Type G, with three rectangular pins. One adapter covers the entire tour.

If you are travelling from outside the UK or Ireland, you will need one. A universal travel adapter with USB and USB-C ports is the simplest all-in-one solution.

[View plug type](#)

Packing

Pack for usefulness rather than volume. Most people bring more than they use — and on a tour with several hotel changes, lighter luggage is noticeably easier to live with.

We use audio listening devices on walking tours — disposable wired headphones are provided. These are not Bluetooth, so wireless earbuds will not connect. You are welcome to bring your own wired pair if you prefer.

Laundry access can vary by hotel and timing on this tour — it is best to pack as if you will not have it.

Luggage allowance: 1 suitcase up to 23kg / 50lbs, plus 1 soft hand-luggage bag. The hand bag must be soft-sided with no wheels or telescopic handle — space on the coach is limited and soft bags fit much more easily. Label both bags clearly before leaving home. Suitcase delivery to your room can take around 30 minutes after check-in — keep toiletries, medications or anything you need on arrival in your hand luggage.



The rhythm of it

This itinerary moves through a lot of Britain and Ireland — from the English countryside and historic cities up through Scotland, across to Ireland, and back again. Each part of it feels different from the last, and that shift is part of what the tour is built around.

This tour really is as much about the journey as it is the destinations. Some days the best moments happen between places — coastlines appearing as we approach a crossing, the landscape stretching out as we head north into Scotland, a stretch of road where people go quiet and just watch the view.

The pace of a highlights tour means some days are busier than others. There will be earlier starts, longer travel days mixed in with slower ones, and ferry crossings that are transitions as much as they are travel.

The weather across this part of the world is part of the experience too. Rain in the morning, sunshine by lunchtime, jacket back on by evening — that's fairly normal here, and it adds to the character rather than taking away from it.

We take it step by step. I'll always let you know what's coming up, what to bring for the day, and what you can leave on the coach and not worry about yet.



On the coach

Seat rotation happens daily, and I'll explain the system clearly on Day One.

Snacks are absolutely fine. Just avoid hot food, hot drinks and anything likely to melt, spill or perfume the entire coach by lunchtime. Please keep your seat area tidy — it's a shared space and it makes a real difference to everyone's day.

On ferry crossing days, your main suitcase travels with the coach — keep your day bag with you, and a layer handy for the sailing.

Seatbelts on whenever you are seated — it's a simple habit that matters.



Comfort stops

We plan regular comfort stops along the way. There may also be a WC on board the coach, but most people find the stops easier.

When getting on and off the coach, take your time and use the handrail.



Hotels vary

One night you may be in a modern hotel; the next in a more historic property with a different character and layout. That variety is part of travelling through Britain and Ireland rather than staying in one standard hotel every night.

Air conditioning is not common in the UK or Ireland — it is simply not part of the building culture here. If your room feels warm, reception can sometimes provide a fan.



Our Driver

Our Driver is a huge part of what makes the journey run smoothly — navigating a coach through Britain and Ireland, including some of the narrower roads and longer touring days, takes real skill and concentration.

By the end of the tour, most groups have a genuine appreciation for just how much goes into it.



Tour timings & inclusions

Our days run to a schedule. Being ready on time — for departures, meals and activities — keeps things on track for everyone in the group.

I'll always let you know what's coming up and what to be prepared for. All we ask is that you're there on time, ready to go.



Security

Keep your passport, cards and valuables secure and close to you, particularly in busier city areas and at transport hubs. A small bag that stays close to your body is worth considering on busier sightseeing days.

A little awareness in crowded places goes a long way.

STAYING CONNECTED



WhatsApp

I use WhatsApp for simple reminders and day-to-day updates while we are travelling. It is optional, but it usually makes the small daily details easier.

1

Download and set up WhatsApp before you travel if you do not already use it.

[Download WhatsApp](#)

2

Save my number — it is in your welcome email, or use the WhatsApp link at the top of this page.

3

Send me a message with your name so I know you are set up.

Travelling with someone? It helps if both of you message me, just in case phones get separated during the trip.

Most hotels and many public places offer Wi-Fi.

If you are planning to rely on mobile data, it is worth checking roaming options with your provider before travel. Some people use an eSIM as a simple alternative for staying connected across multiple countries.

If you'd rather not use WhatsApp, that's fine — everything important will still reach you.

LATER ON TOUR

★ A few practical things for later

You do not need to make all of these decisions before we meet. They become much easier once you can see the pace of the tour and what suits you.

★ Optional experiences

Optional experiences are available throughout the tour, and in my experience they're often the moments that stick — a chance to go a bit further into the places we're already visiting, in a way that's hard to organise on your own.

I'll walk you through everything once we're underway. No pressure at all, but worth keeping an open mind.

Money & cards

Cards are widely accepted throughout Britain and Ireland, but a small amount of cash is still useful for smaller cafés, local stops and gratuities for Local Specialists who join us for sightseeing.

The Republic of Ireland uses the Euro (€). England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland use Pounds Sterling (£). You will move between both currency zones during the tour — small ATM withdrawals as you go are usually simpler than carrying large amounts of both from home.

Gratuities

Some gratuities are included in your tour price — portage and restaurant tips on included meals, for example. Tips for your Travel Director and Driver are separate unless pre-paid.

Guidance is in your Trafalgar documents, and you can ask me on tour if you are unsure. This does not need to be solved on the first morning.

CONTACT



Questions before we begin?

Save my contact now, and keep your official joining instructions somewhere easy to find. That is enough for the moment.

Joel Plunkett

Travel Director · Trafalgar

Phone / WhatsApp

+44 7496 055 950

WhatsApp is usually the easiest way to reach me during the trip.

Instagram



Homepage



Email me



Urgent before departure?

Before the tour begins, I may occasionally be travelling or finishing another tour, but I will always get back to you as soon as I can.

If something is time-sensitive before Day 1, please check your welcome email for European Guest Services contact details.

Once we are together, things usually become much more straightforward day to day.



Final note

England, Scotland, Ireland — there is a lot ahead of us, and I'm looking forward to every part of it. 🇬🇧 See you in London.

A personal guide from your Travel Director. For official timings, inclusions and operational details, refer to your Trafalgar documents.